

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Why? Okay? So I'm going to start by asking some sociodemographic questions, more quickly, and then we'll really talk about the research topic, which is the quality of relationships.

Speaker 2 [00:00:17] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:19] How old are you? I am [20-25]. And how long have you and [Partner's Name] been together?

Speaker 2 [00:00:31] It's been [1-5] years and [1-5] months.

Speaker 1 [00:00:37] And do you have children? No, right? Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:00:45] I live with my mom, dad, and mom.

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] And is your main source of income your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:00:54] Currently, I am an [occupation] at the [Company].

Speaker 1 [00:01:01] No, I don't think so. Only if you want to.

Speaker 2 [00:01:05] That's fine, it's all good.

Speaker 1 [00:01:09] And how would you like us to refer to [Partner's Name], as girlfriend, partner, or a specific name?

Speaker 2 [00:01:18] It could be partner, girlfriend, whatever you prefer.

Speaker 1 [00:01:24] Maybe I'll use [Partner's Name]'s name then, I'm not sure.

Speaker 2 [00:01:28] No problem.

Speaker 1 [00:01:29] So, can you tell me? Wait. Let the helicopter pass. Can you tell me your story, like a love story? How did you meet?

Speaker 2 [00:01:47] It's a bit long, but I'll try to summarize. We've known each other basically since we were teenagers, pre-teens. I studied with her in the [grade level]. I was about [11-15], [11-15] years old, I think. But we have always been friends since then. And then, around my [year] and her [grade level], if I'm not mistaken, we kissed for the first time at a [event]. But after that, we didn't pursue anything. In [Year], we continued being friends, already knew each other, and had already kissed. Then, in [Month] [Year], we started dating. Since then, it's been about [1-5] years and [6-10] months, to be specific.

Speaker 1 [00:02:54] Cool, that's a long time.

Speaker 2 [00:02:58] A long time.

Speaker 1 [00:03:00] And how would you compare the quality of your relationship with your friends' relationships, if you know couples among your friends? Comparing the quality of the relationship, I know it's a weird question, but to compare, like...

Speaker 2 [00:03:23] I believe that, comparing with some, of course, I have many friends who date, but overall, I think our quality is better, right? I think in terms of freedom and companionship. Also, because of the time we've known each other, we already know everything about each other, both good and bad traits. So, I believe the quality is better overall, compared to others.

Speaker 1 [00:03:56] Got it. Do you mind saying how many romantic partners you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:04:08] As for a girlfriend, it's only [Partner's Name].

Speaker 1 [00:04:15] So it's to compare the current relationship with the previous one. But since there wasn't another girlfriend...

Speaker 2 [00:04:22] No, as for a long-term, committed relationship, it's only her. Other than that, I don't count.

Speaker 1 [00:04:39] And for you, what makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:04:45] For me, I think it's freedom, because despite having many things in common, we have different interests at different levels. So, I believe each person should have their own space to go out, she with her friends, me with mine. We also have mutual friends and go out together. I think quality time is important too. Companionship, understanding when the other person is not feeling well, understanding everything that might happen. So, I believe that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:05:31] High quality. And low quality, besides the absence of what you mentioned? Like, characteristics that are of low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:05:41] I think maybe excessive jealousy. I don't know if it contradicts what I said, but excessive jealousy and control over the other's life. Like saying, "You can't do this." Of course, there are things we don't like in each other, both personal and family-related. But I think excessive control and jealousy are the main issues. A bit of jealousy is normal sometimes, but excessive control and jealousy, and lack of conversation. Conversation is essential in all aspects. So, I believe it's that. I hope I'm being clear in my response. But I believe that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:06:49] Understood, makes sense. And what is most important in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:57] Besides companionship, it's communication, especially communication, companionship, affection, love, and also freedom, mainly.

Speaker 1 [00:07:17] And now a more philosophical question, what is love to you?

Speaker 2 [00:07:29] Wow, that's a tough one. For me? Wow! Let me think for a bit.

Speaker 1 [00:07:43] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:07:45] I think it's about thinking about the other person, about what's best for them, without overstepping your own characteristics, but always thinking about the other person's well-being, to avoid conflicts, considering how the other person feels, the way you talk, the way you act, always trying to think. Like, if the person likes sushi, trying to make small gestures that make the other person happy. I particularly like surprises. So, I like to surprise the other person. I believe that in these little things, love is found. There isn't a big definition, but if there was, it would be that love is found in small things.

Speaker 1 [00:08:47] Makes sense. Sorry about the dog. So, in a relationship, for you, love is like caring, protecting, doing what the other person likes, and receiving what you like. Basically that.

Speaker 2 [00:09:00] Companionship, quality time with the other person, affection, love. I think there are many ways to describe it.

Speaker 1 [00:09:10] Yes, love manifests in these characteristics.

Speaker 2 [00:09:17] Yes, especially in the small things. If I had to sum it up, it would be in the small things of everyday life. It's not about big things like buying jewelry or a car for the other person. If someone can do that, it can be a gesture too, but I think it's mainly in the small things, like thinking about the other person, buying a chocolate, a book, something the person wanted, something simple to show you care.

Speaker 1 [00:09:54] And how do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you? What does she do that makes you think, "Wow, she really loves me"?

Speaker 2 [00:10:03] I think it's these things too. She always thinks about me, like buying me gifts that I like, making me feel good with words of affection and emotional support. Not just material things, but love and care. Also, because we've known each other for a long time, we know what makes each other happy or sad. So, it's all these things she does, the companionship, the affection, and always trying to make me happy and feel good.

Speaker 1 [00:11:04] Now, about conflicts in general, from your general opinion and based on your experience, what are the conflicts you see in relationships or that you experience in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:22] In general?

Speaker 1 [00:11:24] Yes, in general.

Speaker 2 [00:11:26] I think the main conflict in all relationships is communication. I think it's a strong point, but sometimes it fails, leading to conflicts, big or small, depending on the situation.

Clear communication about what you like and don't like is crucial. It's like an agreement, and each couple has their own type of relationship with certain agreements. Sometimes these agreements break, and communication is key to understanding and resolving conflicts.

Speaker 1 [00:12:38] Do you and [Partner's Name] have disagreements? How do you resolve them? Is there something common that you argue about?

Speaker 2 [00:12:50] We don't argue much, but sometimes due to routine or being extremely busy, we might have disagreements about quality time. If we don't prioritize our time together, it can cause conflicts. So, I think that's it. It's not very frequent, and it depends on how our lives are at the moment.

Speaker 1 [00:13:33] So, it's not very frequent or doesn't have a defined frequency, and it's more about how each of you is doing?

Speaker 2 [00:13:42] Yes, it depends. For example, despite having many similarities, she plans to have a certain routine. For instance, she wants to work in the [field], which has a certain routine. I've always had a more entrepreneurial mindset, which has a different dynamic. We talk about this, and sometimes it can lead to disagreements. But it's something we can work through. I don't have anything definitively planned for my future, because I also think about continuing our relationship. So, it's something we discuss, aiming for the future, which might cause disagreements.

Speaker 1 [00:14:45] When you resolve things through conversation, do you go to a specific place you like to talk? Or do you manage to resolve things wherever?

Speaker 2 [00:14:56] We talk wherever, in the car, at home, or in a restaurant. It's all based on conversation and dialogue. I believe everything can be resolved through conversation, pondering each other's points and trying to understand what the other wants.

Speaker 1 [00:15:25] Besides conversation, do you have any other strategies to maintain your relationship? Besides love, because we know love alone isn't enough. So, besides conversation and love, how do you maintain it?

Speaker 2 [00:15:41] I think we try to break the routine sometimes. Like going to different restaurants, doing different activities, because after a long time, routine can set in. So, we try to save money to travel. Traveling strengthens the relationship. We love traveling, especially to the beach, discovering new places and cultures. Even if we can't travel often, just going to nearby places helps.

Speaker 1 [00:16:51] That's great. I think this relationship is good, apparently. But I need you to say why you think so.

Speaker 2 [00:17:07] I think so because I don't have many friends who continue doing what they like after they start dating. Some stop doing what they enjoy. I think that's one of the main factors. For example, I like playing [sport]. Some friends stopped playing after they started

dating. I don't see the relationship as a prison. It's about two people who love each other, have common interests but also have their own lives. So, I think it's good because of the companionship, dialogue, freedom, and trust. Trust is very important. For example, if I go out alone, she trusts me. She worries more about my safety than about other things. So, it's about having that trust and understanding.

Speaker 1 [00:18:57] Do you think being in a relationship has changed you as a person? How?

Speaker 2 [00:19:08] Quite a lot. I started dating very young, at [16-20], in my [year] of high school. At that age, everyone is immature, especially boys, I think. But I've matured emotionally and in how I treat others. We've learned a lot from each other. My appearance and clothes have changed a bit too. I think I've learned a lot, especially because I study [program], which has helped a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:20:29] And you said she learned a lot from you. How do you think she has changed?

Speaker 2 [00:20:50] I think, for example, in financial matters. She didn't have much control over her finances, and I helped her with that because I'm very organized in that aspect. That's the first thing that comes to mind. Also, patience and emotional aspects in general. I think we've both learned a lot from each other.

Speaker 1 [00:22:03] Makes sense. I'll move to the next question, but feel free to add anything else later. Do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure, either physically or emotionally, like she represents a comfort figure?

Speaker 2 [00:22:37] I feel secure because of her affirmative words and the time we've been together. At the beginning, there might be some insecurity, but knowing her as a friend before dating made me feel secure. Trust, companionship, and her always being there for me make me feel secure.

Speaker 1 [00:23:44] And on a scale, let me share my screen, you need to respond to a numerical scale from 1 to 9, indicating how true each statement is for you. There's no need to show the scale now; just answer.

Speaker 2 [00:24:09] Can we discuss it after the interview?

Speaker 1 [00:24:12] Yes, you can discuss it afterward. But during the interview, it's better not to, to avoid influencing each other's responses. So, from 1 to 9, how much do you agree with the statement "My partner truly listens to me"?

Speaker 2 [00:24:49] I think between 8 and 9.

Speaker 1 [00:25:01] And can you justify why that number? Why not a 9 or a 5?

Speaker 2 [00:25:20] Not a 9 because it's hard to be 100% in this aspect. Everyone has a different way of listening and showing they're listening. And sometimes, we have difficult days. Not a 5 because if she didn't listen to me, it would be hard to coexist, and there would be many conflicts.

Speaker 1 [00:26:06] Understood. The same question, but for "My partner cares about my needs."

Speaker 2 [00:26:17] I think it's also an 8 or 8.5.

Speaker 1 [00:26:22] For the same reason?

Speaker 2 [00:26:25] Yes, because she's there for me in difficult times, providing emotional support and any other type of support.

Speaker 1 [00:26:53] Makes sense. I'll stop sharing the screen now, but I'll share it again later. Now, some questions about sexual relations. If you don't want to answer, just let me know. Have you had sexual relations lately? How satisfied are you with the frequency and quality?

Speaker 2 [00:28:11] I'm embarrassed, but I can answer. Yes, but living with our parents impacts it, which can be frustrating.

Speaker 1 [00:28:48] Got it, no problem. I'll share the screen again for a satisfaction scale. How satisfied are you with your relationship overall, considering aspects like love, quality time, companionship, listening, and meeting needs?

Speaker 2 [00:30:07] I think I can answer completely satisfied. There are things to improve, but overall, I'm completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:30:31] How would you rate your satisfaction in the relationship overall? 100% satisfied or like 80%?

Speaker 2 [00:30:58] Currently, I'd say 90-95%. Because there are always things to improve on both sides, but overall, very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:31:33] So, on this scale, it would be between 9 and 9.5?

Speaker 2 [00:31:39] Yes, between 9 and 9.5.

Speaker 1 [00:31:39] Got it. Those were the questions. Sorry for any embarrassment. It's hard to find participants. I'll send you an email with the consent form. Just mark yes and sign it in the Google Doc. Also, I'll send a thank you note. If you know any other couples to recommend, please share their contacts, and I'll explain the research to them.

Speaker 2 [00:32:39] Sure, I can recommend some. It's hard to find participants, especially for relationship research. I'll pass on their contacts, and you can mention my name.

Speaker 1 [00:33:02] Thank you so much for participating! This was the interview. I'll stop the recording now.